

The Sandbox

Bukhari Chancery Persian Textbook Development

dek-barin

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Grammatical Explanation

The most common way of expressing similarity or equivalence in modern Iranian Persian is the Arabic loan word **دک**, which is used in the same manner as the etymologically Persian **مانند** / **مانند**: both words are common in both dialects, with **مانند** more frequent in Tajik. For instance, "a lion is not like him": **دک** / **مانند**.

Central Asian Turkic languages usually express similarity with a postfix: **-dek** / **-dek**. For instance, "fight like a lion": **sherdek kurashing**.

Central Asian Persian historical texts tend to favor a construction more similar in function to **-dek** than to **مانند**-i or **مِسل**-i, in that it is a postfix. For instance, "fight like a lion": **دک**.

Students more familiar with classical Persian should take care not to mistake this homophone for **بار** ('sublime,' 'lofty') or the contraction **bar + en** ("at / on this").

Examples

bukh:

uzb:

fars:

eng: The words of the aforementioned individuals seemed to be truthful, and because they seemed to be Muslims of pure heart, I sent them with an escort to the royal court.

bukh:

uzb:

fars:

eng:

Comments: bukh:

uzb:

fars:

eng:

Historical-Grammatical Exploration

In some colloquial dialects of Tajik (e.g., in Surkhondaryo), the word rang (lit. 'color') is used for this purpose: piyāla-i man rang-i piyāla-i tō-st ('my cup os is just like your cup').

References

- Persian: Perry (365-370).
- Chaghatay: Schluessel (158-159).